Mind Mysteries
CLARITY MEETS COMPASSION

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Informed Consent Form

Know your therapist

Hi, I am Anoop Inder Kaur your psychotherapist. I am a Rehabilitation Council Of India (RCI) licenced Clinical Psychologist providing online/ offline psychotherapy / counselling services and work at Landmark Hospital, Sector 33, Chandigarh.

I hold the following degrees:

Professional Diploma in Clinical Psychology (RCI), Masters in Clinical Psychology, Diploma in Counselling and Guidance.

I am a trauma informed therapist and trained and certified in various therapeutic modalities such as CBT, DBT, CPT, Attachment based therapies, Internal Family Systems, Couples Therapy, etc.

Welcome to my practice!!

I understand that it takes a lot of effort to reach out for support with regard to mental health. I appreciate your effort in this regard. A consent from the client is very important to initiate therapy sessions. Therefore, by signing this form, you will be providing me the consent to address your psychological concerns. This document contains information about my professional services and ethical policies.

Please read it carefully. We can discuss any questions that you may have. When you sign this document, it will represent an agreement between us.

General information about Psychotherapy

Psychotherapy is a process to help individuals experiencing significant emotional distress that interrupts their wellbeing, including one's physical health, personal and professional relationships and productivity. Psychotherapy begins with the therapist understanding the background of the person seeking help and the concerns that led them to seek help.

Following this, the client and the therapist come to an agreement about the process & goals of therapy. It is a two-way contract, involving effort on both people.

Advantages and risks of psychotherapy

Therapy can have benefits and risks. Since therapy often involves discussing challenging aspects of your life, you may find yourself experiencing intense difficult emotions. These are normal, are a part of therapy and you will be held through these emotions. On the other hand, apart from significant symptoms reduction, psychotherapy often leads to better relationships with self and others, enhanced capacity to regulate oneself and brings in better ability to respond objectively to situations. There is no definite timeline. Every client is unique; hence, every client will experience therapy in their own unique ways, and will need their own time and space to heal and bring about change that they're looking for.

Tele-psychotherapy

Tele-psychotherapy refers to the provision of psychotherapy services using telecommunication technologies including email, text messaging, video conferencing, online chat, messaging, or phone call. Tele-psychotherapy would typically involve all aspects of psychotherapy, except that it would be offered using telecommunication technologies.

I offer tele psychotherapy through either video conferencing (Google meet/ Zoom/WhatsApp)

Possible limitations to care (Tele psychotherapy):

- I understand that video/audio consultation has its own limitations as compared to in-person sessions and some details could potentially be missed out despite the psychotherapist's best efforts.
- I understand that tele-psychotherapy services are by appointment only and that these consultations are not suitable for help during a crisis or emergency.
- I understand that the psychotherapist would use their professional discretion to provide required recommendations about the type of professional service (tele-psychotherapy/ in- person psychotherapy/ crisis intervention/ emergency services) that may be required at any given point of time.
- I agree to not hold my psychotherapist responsible, should any adverse events, such as lack of improvement, deterioration or situations of potential risk of harm to self or others, occur during online consultation.
- I understand that in such situations I may be advised to obtain treatment at the nearest available mental health or emergency service.
- Despite safety measures taken, there are chances for breach in security in technology. In such instances, both client and psychotherapist will not hold the other responsible for the breach.

I understand that this audio/ video consultation is strictly confidential. I agree to provide a secure line/connection for these consultations, in a relatively quiet and private space. I understand that my therapist will not audio or video record the session (either on mobile, using an app or online) without my consent.

Prepaid Appointments and Cancellation Policy

Appointments are confirmed only after payment. Once an appointment is scheduled, payment needs to be done at-least 48 hours prior to the appointment time. Re-scheduling or cancelling sessions need to be done by intimating at least 24 hours in advance, beyond which 50% of the session fee will be deducted. There will be no refund if a session is cancelled or rescheduled 12 hours before the appointment time.

Sessions timings is fixed and cannot be extended if you are late as your therapist has to honour the next appointment.

During the first 2-3 sessions, we can both decide if we want to continue our therapeutic contract in order to meet your treatment goals or not. If we agree to continue, sessions are of 50 minutes duration, usually once per week, at a time we agree on, although a few sessions may be longer or more frequent.

Professional Fees & mode of payment

The fee can be paid via gpay on 9463880582

Contacting One Another between the sessions

I may not be immediately available by telephone during ongoing sessions. In case you need to contact me, you may message (text / voice) me through Whatsapp (Between 9am to 7pm).

I shall respond at the earliest. In case of emergencies, please get in touch with your psychiatrist/ hospital with psychiatric emergency set-up/ contact tele manas helpline (14416 or 1 800 8914416).

We shall intimate to one another if either of us are taking vacations and cannot be available for holding sessions for some period of time, at-least 1 week prior to our vacation date.

Professional Records

The sessions will not be audio and/or recorded without your permission.

Therapeutic Relationship

The required relationship that a client should have with his/her therapist during the course of therapy is strictly professional. Any other relationship, such as business or personal relationships that a client may have with a therapist may prevent or undermine the effectiveness of the treatment. The therapist cares about helping you but is not in a position to be your friend or to have a social and personal relationship with you. Gifts, bartering, and trading services are not appropriate; hence it would not be appreciated.

Confidentiality

In general, the privacy of all communications between us is private information and shall strictly be maintained confidential. I can only release information about our work to others with your written permission. But there are a few exceptions.

- If you are at a high risk for suicide, serious mental disorder, harm to yourself or any grave danger.
- If you report to have a malicious plan to harm anyone in your life.
- If your case history is demanded by the court of law.
- If you report any abuse, drug peddling or any illegal activity that the law requires us to file a report.
- If you request to break confidentiality and inform another person/professional about certain matters of your life.

In these cases, I will need to notify your next of kin and involve them into the therapy/counselling process and/or refer you to an appropriate specialist who can become a part of the system that can help you. However, before giving them any information, **I will discuss the matter with you.**

> **Also note:**
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> 1. Your therapist may discuss your case history with their supervisor/peer group, keeping your identifying information hidden.
> 2. For administrative and operational purposes some/all of our staff might have access to your information.
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> In case of minors, parents have the right to be informed of your treatment sessions, only to the extent that shall help you, as a family, to understand for resolution and I will discuss the matter with you.

I have read the terms of the contract and agree to them. I also hereby declare that all the information provided by me is true and correct.

Client

NAME

SIGNATURE

DATE

Parent or guardian for clients under 18

NAME

SIGNATURE

DATE

Sending it back. Send the signed form, or a clear photo of it, on WhatsApp to +91 94638 80582 or by email to anoopkaur1712@outlook.com before your first session.

For couples therapy, each partner fills in their own form.